Pablo R Valenzuela, BSA

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Professional Summary

I am a business and finance professional with over 10 years of experience across higher education and nonprofit organizations, supporting financial reporting, budgeting, compliance and operational improvement. I enjoy helping leaders make informed decisions by turning complex financial data into clear, meaningful information. Known for my calm and collaborative leadership style, I adapt quickly to new systems, work effectively across diverse teams and focus on building practical solutions that strengthen financial stewardship and organizational effectiveness.

Professional Experience

Enterprise-Wide Auditor

University of Illinois System | Dec 2023 – Present

- Partner directly with leadership, including the Chancellor's Office and Vice Chancellors, to review, evaluate, and strengthen enterprise-wide financial planning, operational effectiveness and internal controls.
- Perform financial, compliance and operational audits to strengthen system wide financial stewardship and transparency.
- Analyze complex data across systems and translate findings into clear insights for leadership.
- Provide recommendations that support strategic alignment, regulatory compliance and long-range planning.
- Present actionable recommendations to executive stakeholders, directly shaping strategic and efficient initiatives.

Assistant Director of Finance/ Business Administrative Associate (BAA)

University of Illinois at Chicago, College of Liberal Arts & Sciences (BIOS) | Jun 2023 – Nov 2023

- Supported financial operations, including reconciliations, expenditure tracking, and year-end reporting.
- Coordinated budgeting-related activities and ensured alignment with financial policies and priorities.
- Supervised and scheduled accountants, associates and student workers to ensure timely, accurate financial transactions.
- Acted as a bridge between faculty, grant managers and finance teams, helping coordinate budgets and ensure compliance with regulations.
- Improved workflows through analysis of Banner, SAP- Webi , EDDIE and UI Financials data.

Budget Analyst/Assistant Controller

American College of Surgeons | 2016 – 2023

- Produced financial reports supporting leadership review of revenue, expenses, and operational performance.
- Supported budgeting, forecasting, and variance analysis activities.
- Conducted compliance and reimbursement analysis in accordance with GAAP, GASB and FASB standards.
- Led process improvements and reporting automation initiatives.
- Supervised and developed accountants, A/R and A/P staff and partnered with leadership on financial decision-making.

Education

- Master of Public Policy & Civic Analytics-CUPPA (*Expected 2027*) – *University of Illinois Chicago*
- Bachelor of Science in Accounting (*Taxation Specialization*) – *Northeastern Illinois University*
- Economics Coursework – *University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA)*

Skills

- Proficient in financial analysis, budgeting, forecasting, variance analysis, financial reporting, compliance and process improvement.
- Skilled in Compliance & Governance: IDPH, TJC, GAAP, GASB, FASB, federal and state regulations.
- Enterprise-Wide Systems Proficiency: SAP Web Intelligence, EDDIE, OLAP Cube, Banner, My UI Financials, Tableau Dashboards, EPIC Slice/Dice (exposure), Emburse, iBuy, TED, etc.
- Advanced Excel (PivotTables, Lookups)
- Fluent in Spanish (read, write, speak)

What Sets Me Apart

I bring a balance of strong financial expertise and people-focused leadership. Colleagues know me for my calm demeanor, collaborative style and willingness to learn. I enjoy bringing people together, working through challenges and finding practical solutions that support both organizational goals and the people behind them.